

GAME DEVELOPMENT AI CAN DO IT CHALLENGE

TENCENT CLOUD HACKATHON



AI CAN DO IT | Tencent Cloud Hackathon Game

Development Challenge

Challenge Brief

1. Event Overview

The **AI CAN DO IT | Tencent Cloud Hackathon Game Development Challenge** is a global rapid-development challenge for university developers and creators from the game and design communities, centered on **AI-powered game creation**.

This year's event is jointly organized by Tencent Cloud, Tencent Institute of Games, Tencent WeTech Academy, and the Tencent Interactive Entertainment Group (IEG) Social Value Exploration Center. The competition features **five regional divisions** worldwide: Hong Kong & Macao SARs, East China, North China, South China, and Southeast Asia, covering leading universities and game developer communities in China and abroad. Each division will host offline roadshows alongside major industry events such as Tencent Cloud Day, Tencent Cloud City Summit, and the Tencent AI Summit, giving participants a first-hand opportunity to showcase their work and engage with the industry. Participants must use **CodeBuddy** (Tencent Cloud's AI coding assistant) to build a game prototype and deeply integrate AI capabilities into the project, demonstrating new possibilities for game creation in the AI era.

2. Challenge Tracks

This competition offers **three tracks**, each focused on a different creative direction.

Participants may choose one track based on their interests and strengths.

Track 1: Little Red Flower Games (Social Impact Games)

Track Focus

This track supports creators who use games to communicate and respond to real-world social issues. Participants are encouraged to integrate concrete social value or public-interest themes into the game's worldbuilding, core narrative, or primary gameplay loop, creating projects that clearly communicate social values, public-interest concepts, and relevant knowledge while encouraging positive action.

Suggested Directions

Direction 1: Emergency Response and First Aid

Use game-based and scenario-driven design to turn professional knowledge such as emergency evacuation, self-rescue, and mutual aid into interactive experiences that are easy to understand and participate in.

Direction 2: Biodiversity and Environmental Protection

Use ecological protection as the core theme and help players explore issues such as species conservation, ecological balance, carbon emissions, and sustainable development through gameplay. Simulation, management, and strategy-based mechanics can be used to communicate the concept of green development and inspire environmental awareness and action.

Direction 3: Age-Friendly Design and Care for Special Groups

Focus on elderly users, people with disabilities, and other special groups, and promote social inclusion and understanding through accessible design and empathetic storytelling.

Reference Cases

- Eggy Party integrates public-interest interactive levels around fire safety, traffic safety, and ecological protection.
- DreamStar includes dedicated public-interest UGC zones and long-term public-interest gameplay systems.
- Honor of Kings has collaborated on themes such as Great Wall protection, using character skins and story missions to communicate cultural preservation.
- Ant Forest turns users' low-carbon behavior into real-world anti-desertification action through a gamified tree-planting system.
- Putonghua Town helps users learn Mandarin through playful interaction and supports rural education.

Track 2: Cultural Expression Games

Track Focus

Use games as a medium to reveal the beauty of culture. Participants are encouraged to create immersive digital experiences that renew traditional culture and local culture within game worlds, giving culture new life that is perceptible, interactive, and shareable.

Suggested Directions

Direction 1: Urban culture games

Through exploration, puzzles, or simulation-building, they recreate landmarks, history, and local life, allowing players to stroll through streets in digital space and experience unique regional charm and modern pace.



Direction 2: Hometown culture games

Focus on emotional storytelling and interactive customs. Through management, adventure, or narrative choices, players engage with dialects, festivals, food, and traditions, reliving memories and warmth passed down through generations.

Reference Cases

- Honor of Kings and Peacekeeper Elite have continued to collaborate with traditional culture and intangible cultural heritage themes.
- Moonlight Blade recreates Song Dynasty street life, craftsmanship, tea performance, weaving, and other historical scenes.
- Black Myth: Wukong has sparked strong interest in Shanxi cultural heritage, archaeology, and tourism.
- Jinchanchan Zhizhan integrates mythological characters, auspicious–beast motifs, and intangible heritage totems into gameplay systems.
- QQ Speed has designed tracks inspired by village landscapes such as Huangling’s autumn drying fields and traditional settlements.
- Wangxiang Shanhai incorporates ancient villages, rammed–earth housing, and farming elements into the game world.
- QQ Dance blends Citywalk–style exploration with historical districts and contemporary urban scenes.
- Let's Hunt Monsters Together uses historical districts and city landmarks as AR exploration maps.

Track 3: Narrative Games

Track Focus

Use AI to reshape narrative experiences. Participants are encouraged to build rich worlds



and character systems with AI technologies, creating immersive game experiences with intelligent interaction, dynamic story progression, and personalized narrative design, and exploring a new paradigm for “dialogue between people and game worlds” in the AI era.

Suggested Directions

Participants may create within the following narrative genres, including but not limited to:

Direction 1: Management and Simulation

Build a virtual world that players must manage and operate, using AI-driven NPC systems to enable dynamic character interaction and event generation. NPCs should not simply function as quest givers, but as “digital residents” with their own behavioral logic, memory, and emotional feedback, making the management experience feel more alive and believable. For example, in an AI-driven town simulation, residents may have independent daily schedules and social relationships; in a restaurant simulator, AI customers may have individualized preferences and feedback; every player decision can drive dynamic changes in the world state.

Direction 2: Story-Driven Games

Create a strong story-centered experience in which AI generates the world background and key visuals, and intelligent NPCs drive plot progression, branching choices, and multiple endings. Each player choice can trigger AI-driven narrative turns. For example, in a mystery game, AI NPCs can adjust clue release based on the player’s deduction progress; in a role-playing adventure, AI can automatically build character relationship networks and world history; AI agents can generate key visual direction and concept art as part of the core visual identity of the game.

Direction 3: Open Exploration

Create an open world co-built by AI, where players can freely explore, converse, and encounter AI characters with independent personalities in a non-linear storytelling experience. The focus is on **emergent narrative**: the story is not fully pre-written, but



grows naturally through interaction between AI and the player. AI agents can support world construction and key visual generation, while free-form dialogue with AI NPCs can make each playthrough narratively unique.

Reference Cases

- Detroit: Become Human builds a deep interactive narrative through branching plots and character fate choices.
- Stardew Valley demonstrates a strong combination of management simulation and NPC social systems.
- AI Dungeon offers open-ended narrative adventure built on large language models, where players can freely converse to advance the story.
- The Sims series uses AI-like behavior systems to drive autonomous character interaction and emergent storytelling.



3. Project Requirements

Project Format

Each submission must be **a complete, standalone, playable game prototype**, rather than a feature module, level, or plugin for an existing game. The project should provide a full gameplay loop, including a clear gameplay objective, interactive core mechanics, and a basic start-to-finish flow.

Technical Requirement

- The project must be deployed in a browser-accessible environment and submitted with a directly accessible online link, such as a CloudStudio deployment.

Development Tool Requirement

All projects **must use CodeBuddy** (Tencent Cloud's AI coding assistant) as the core development tool. CodeBuddy provides AI-assisted programming, code generation, and intelligent debugging to help participants efficiently build and develop their game prototypes. Participants must export the CodeBuddy conversation history used during development as one of the review materials at submission time.

AI Creation Requirement

This competition emphasizes that **AI is not only an assistant, but also a creative engine**.

In addition to using CodeBuddy for development, each submission **must include at least one module in which the content is fully generated by AI**:

Creation Module	Description	Recommended Tool	Product Link	Suggested Usage
Worldbuilding & Story	AI generates the game's world setting, including background story, historical context, faction	CodeBuddy (China / Global)	Tencent Cloud Code	Install the IDE extension, plugin, or CLI for AI-assisted coding and development.



	relationships, and rule systems. The AI-generated setting should serve as the core narrative foundation of the project.		Assistant / CodeBuddy	
		CodeBuddy Genie	GenieAI	Web service with Google sign-in support for no-code creation workflows.
Game Key Art	AI generates the main visual concept assets of the game, such as character concepts, environment concept art, and UI art, demonstrating AI capability in visual creation.	WorkBuddy	WorkBuddy	Install WorkBuddy for local productivity workflows and asset creation.
		Tencent Cloud MPS	Tencent MPS on ClawHub	Use natural language to generate images and videos, remove subtitles, add digital watermarks, enhance quality, and transcode or compress media.
		Game Video Enhancement	Game Scene Enhancement Demo	Improve game visuals with AI through deblurring, detail enhancement, super-resolution, and color enhancement.
		Miora	miora.de sign	Web service for producing game art assets and creative video content.
Game Security Architecture	AI generates a game IOA (intelligent operations analysis) security architecture. The solution should cover at least one foundational protection function such as agent behavior safety, player identity authentication, data interaction validation, or abnormal behavior detection.	EdgeOne Security Acceleration Skill	Tencent EdgeOne on ClawHub / SkillHub	Use the EdgeOne skill to provide end-to-end security protection and a smooth gameplay experience for launch.
		HaS-Anonymizer	SkillHub	Protect game information exchange and avoid exposing sensitive information externally.
Audio Performance	AI generates the game's music, sound effects, or voice acting as a	WorkBuddy	WorkBuddy	Use WorkBuddy skills to create voice content and other audio assets.



	core part of the auditory narrative. Music should align with the world setting, faction identity, and historical context; voice acting should fit character profiles, relationships, and story logic to support immersive storytelling.	VoxFlow Studio	VoxFlow Studio	Generate voice output from sample audio and fine-tune audio style for the game.
		GVoice	Tencent RTC Registration	Supports real-time voice, voice messages, speech-to-text, voice safety, recording, and AI-powered voice interaction across platforms.
		CloudStudio	CloudStudio.net	Create applications with open-source frameworks for audio and video content production.

Note: Participants may choose one or more of the modules above for AI creation. We encourage teams to apply AI deeply across multiple modules to fully demonstrate their creative capability.

4. Online Training Camp & Project Diagnosis

A “Learn + Diagnose” dual-track program running throughout the competition’s development phase — **8 sessions in total, held weekly**. Each session features an industry guest sharing practical insights on a core game development topic, paired with hands-on AI tool demonstrations. Alongside each session, **10 project diagnosis slots** are open: selected submissions receive live, targeted feedback and improvement suggestions from the guest on the spot.

Session Schedule

Session	Topic
Session 1	Competition Brief Deep-Dive



Session 2	Rapid Prototyping with AI
Session 3	AI-Generated Game Worldbuilding
...	Stay tuned

Project Diagnosis

10 diagnosis slots available per session — first come, first served. Applicants must submit a playable demo link, a description of the key challenges they are facing, and a demo video (under 3 minutes). Feedback will be given live based on each project's actual state.

5. Competition Format

Overall Flow

Online Development (Project Creation) -> Campus Selection -> Regional Preliminaries (Offline Roadshow) -> Grand Final (Extreme Development & Global Roadshow)

Participation Flow

Online Registration -> Receive CodeBuddy Credits -> Project Development -> Project Submission

- **Registration:** Participants register through the sign-up form distributed by their school and join the event community for Q&A and updates.
- **Credit Support:** After successful registration, participants will receive Tencent Cloud CodeBuddy credits for AI-powered development during the project creation process.
- **Submission:** Teams must complete their project within the required timeline and submit the following materials through the designated form:

Submission Item	Description
Project Web Link	A browser-accessible URL where the project can be experienced online
Game Demo Video	A complete demonstration of the core gameplay, AI features, and project highlights
Project Introduction PPT	Includes the project overview, selected track, explanation of AI-created modules (such as worldbuilding, complex gameplay code, key art), and team member information
CodeBuddy Conversation History	The CodeBuddy chat history used during the project development process
Social Media Post Link (Bonus)	Publish the project on social media platforms such as Xiaohongshu, YouTube, X, or WeChat Channels with the hashtags #CodeBuddy and #TencentCloudHackathon , and submit the post link

Regional Schedule

Division	Roadshow Timing	Location
Hong Kong & Macao SARs	July	Hong Kong SAR
East China	July	Shanghai
North China	June	Beijing
South China	July	Wuhan
Southeast Asia	July	Indonesia
Grand Final	September	Shenzhen

6. Preliminary Judging Mechanism

Projects will be evaluated across the following three dimensions for a total score of 100 points:

Evaluation Dimension	Score	Key Review Focus
Theme Alignment	30 points	Whether the project closely aligns with the selected track, clearly communicates its core idea, and delivers a complete and thoughtful thematic expression
Use of AI Tools	40 points	Whether CodeBuddy is used effectively for development, and the depth and originality of AI modules such as worldbuilding, intelligent NPCs, game key art, and AI audio/video



Game Quality	30 points	Playability, creativity, and overall balance of the gameplay experience
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Bonus Item

- **Social Media Reach** (+5 points): Publish the project on social media platforms such as Xiaohongshu, YouTube, X, or WeChat Channels with the hashtags #CodeBuddy and #TencentCloudHackathon.

Review Process

Project Submission -> Initial School Screening -> Regional Roadshow Review -> Grand Final Review

- **Campus Selection:** Each partner school submits projects to Tencent Cloud and selects one outstanding project from its own submissions to form a school representative team for the regional roadshow.
- **Regional Roadshow Review:** Representative teams from participating schools present their projects live at the offline roadshow. Judges score each project based on theme alignment, use of AI tools, and game quality, and select regional award winners and teams advancing to the grand final.
- **Grand Final Review:** Winning teams from each region gather at the grand final for the final competition through extreme development and a global roadshow presentation. Final rankings are determined by a combination of judge scoring and public voting.

7. Participant Benefits and Awards

Technical Resource Support

All participants will receive CodeBuddy credits to support project development:





Channel	CodeBuddy Credits
Overseas Regions (including Hong Kong & Macao SARs)	2,000 credits per participant

Regional Awards

Award	Prize
Regional Top 10	Tokens worth RMB 5,000

Grand Final Awards

Award	Quota	Prize
First Prize	1	RMB 100,000
Second Prize	3	RMB 50,000
Third Prize	5	RMB 20,000
Merit Award	6	RMB 10,000

Additional Benefits

Benefit	Description
Final Interview Fast Track	Outstanding participants may enter the fast-track final interview process for Tencent IEG and CSIG internships
Project Support	Outstanding projects may directly advance to the 2026 Tencent Game Creation Competition and may receive opportunities for investment, publishing, and





	incubation support
Official Certification	An official Tencent Cloud certification certificate with a unique online verification code and lookup entry